Jude 1–2 — Leader / Learner Guide

Standing in the Storm: Grace, Mercy, and Peace · Study 1 of 6 · Source: The Gospel Vault

Big Idea and Context

> **Big idea:** Before any warning, Jude tells believers who they are — called, beloved, and kept for Jesus Christ — and prays that mercy, peace, and love would overflow in them.

Jude's letter is urgent, but it does not start with the threat. It starts with identity and intercession. The two verses are the footing for everything that follows.

- **vv. 1–2:** who we are and what Jude prays.
- **vv. 3–4:** the crisis that changed his letter.
- **vv. 5–16:** warnings from history and portraits of false teachers.
- **vv. 17–23:** what the kept do.
- **vv. 24–25:** He is able — doxology.

Three Words for Believers — Anchor Verse 1

Verse	What it says	Teaching point
v. 1	the called	The ordinary name for believers (Rom. 1:6–7). Something already true of them.
v. 1	beloved in God the Father	Some manuscripts read "sanctified." Love is the realm believers live in; Jude repeats "beloved" in vv. 3, 17, 20.
v. 1	kept for Jesus Christ	Perfect passive: God did it and it stays in force. "For" names the destination — the presentation of v. 24.

The keeping thread: *tēreō* appears in vv. 1, 6, 13, 21 and the related *phylassō* in v. 24. God keeps believers for Christ, keeps rebels for judgment, and tells believers to keep themselves in His love — different levels of one truth.

Teaching Flow

1. **The author (v. 1a).** A slave of Jesus Christ, once a skeptic (John 7:5; Acts 1:14). Authority comes from whom he serves.
2. **The recipients (v. 1b).** Called, beloved, kept. Take time on the perfect passive "kept."
3. **The greeting (v. 2).** Mercy, peace, love — in that order — and a prayer that they overflow.

Clarify While Teaching

- **Same Jude?** Most take this Jude as the half-brother of Jesus and of James (Matt. 13:55; Mark 6:3). He does not use that title himself.
- **"Sanctified" or "beloved"?** A copying variant; both are true. The NASB reads "beloved."
- **Does "kept" mean I can't fail?** It speaks of God's keeping of our standing. The letter later calls believers to keep themselves in His love (v. 21) — a call to walk in what is already ours.
- **Reformed vs. Free Grace:** Reformed teaching ties keeping to the believer's perseverance; Free Grace rests it on God's promise and power alone. We read the letter through the second.

Discussion and Close

1. When trouble comes, what is your first instinct — to try to hold on tighter, or to remember you are being held?
2. Which of Jude's three words — called, beloved, kept — do you need most today? Why?
3. What would it look like to pray Jude 2 for someone in your group this week?

Close: Point ahead to vv. 3–4: Jude meant to write about "our common salvation" and instead had to write about defending it. The kept can contend because they are already kept.